



Bladeless fans!

Dyson's newest, the Pure Cool Link, has an air purifier, and is connected to your wifi, and has no blades. <http://dgit.in/bldlsfans>



God of War beyond Greece?

The new God of War 4, announced at E3, will be dabbling in Norse mythology. <http://dgit.in/GoW4x>

LG G5

Modular design FTW?

Creating the most innovative smartphone of the year is a risk, but LG took it upon itself to do so. The LG G5 is no doubt innovative, and opens up opportunities for the market to take a new turn. That said, LG's execution is less than ideal. We'll start with the modular bit.

A button on the left side of the G5 unlocks the bottom module of the G5, and this is where the magic happens. You can slide in other modules to enhance your smartphone. However, it's anything but intuitive. Getting used to the button takes time, which is by design. You don't want to press this button by mistake. That said, after you've pressed it, you have to pretty much yank the module out of the G5, which is dangerous when in a hurry. Your phone may, and in the long run, will, fly out of your hand.

The battery comes out with this bottom module and there's no reserve power in the G5 to keep it turned on. Imagine a situation where you need to click a quick photo and are switching to the Camera Plus module to it. You'll miss the moment because turning on the G5 will take a few seconds. It's not that the G5 takes a lot of time to boot, just that booting it again and again is annoying. Moreover, there's a locking mechanism inside, which raises the question as to whether it'll be damaged over the long term.

Lastly, the fact that the G5 has been launched with only two modules doesn't inspire confidence in the future. LG needs to sell large numbers of this device in order to get developers excited and create enough modules.

Modularity apart, the LG G5 is a pretty great phone. The Snapdragon 820 is fast, and 4GB of DDR4 RAM, combined with UFS 2.0 storage makes it even smoother. Apps load fast, but browsing performance is slightly lower than a Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge (Exynos model). For instance, Facebook's instant articles load after a split second stutter. We're nitpicking, sure, but it's also a flagship and at a 50K price point, most would nitpick.



Price
₹46,990

The LG G5 also has a 16MP primary camera on the back, accompanied by an 8MP fish eye camera next to it. The 16MP camera on the G5 focuses on details, instead of brightness instead of details. Given the right light, your photos will be great, if a tad dim. Under low light, the G5 provides good photos, with accurate colours and good details.

The 8MP camera is a fish eye lens, and achieves 135 degree wide angle coverage. In doing so, it creates barrel distortion, which is a property of fish eye lenses. You have to understand the lens well enough to take good photos with it. Your subjects will also look distant, which is another property of fish eye lenses. The 8MP camera is also not well suited to low light photos, or videos.

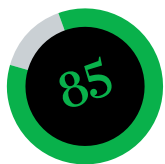
Moving to the build and design, you come to another grey area. While the LG G5 is delightfully ergonomic, metallic phones usually feel more.... metallic. This isn't the anodised aluminium you get on an iPhone or other flagship devices. The looks unique, and is ergonomic, but it doesn't feel as premium as a flagship smartphone should.

Lastly, the display on the LG G5 is a big strength for the phone. It has a QHD display, with 544 ppi pixel density. It's easily amongst our favourite displays in the market today. It doesn't oversaturate colours like an AMOLED display, and gives you double the brightness that a mid-ranged phone would.

On the battery front, the LG G5 lasts for about 10 hours on heavy usage, which is pretty much the industry standard today. This includes 4 phone calls, 35 minutes of gaming, a few photos clicked, a short video and some more texts and emails. It's not the best battery life, and the Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge did last a bit longer, but only a bit.

To sum up, if you're buying a LG G5, you're buying a very good smartphone. Yes, the execution isn't done right, but there are good qualities as well. If LG does things right, you'll have more innovative modules to buy in the future, and this phone may impress you more than any other.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.3 inch QHD;
SoC: 2.15 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 820; **RAM:** 4GB DDR4; **Operating System:** Android Marshmallow;
Battery: 2800 mAh;
Camera: 16MP + 8MP (Wide Angle) Rear, 8MP front camera

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